The Autumn Checklist

- [ ] **Chase a Scent**

  Fall is full of wonderful smells, that can trigger powerful memories and feelings. Whether it's lighting a candle, visiting a bakery or making a simmer pot at home, experience a scent that brings you warmth and comfort.

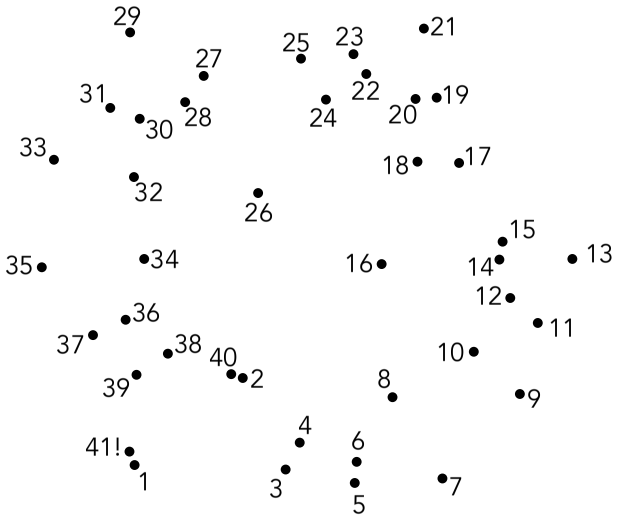
- [ ] **Lay in the Grass**

  Stare up into the sky. Hold the ground beneath you. Imagine yourself holding the entire planet in your hands while you lay above it all. Think about how vast this giant ball beneath you is. Then imagine Earth spinning and flying through space, while you hold on, riding along its path.

- [ ] **Text a Friend**

  Just to tell them that you're thinking of them. And that you're happy they're in your life. Perhaps it will feel out of the blue, but that's part of the joy of it. We all love hearing that we have a positive impact on those closest to us.

Connect the Dots



Hints

These puzzles are meant to be enjoyed. If they've become frustrating instead of fun, *please* use these hints. That's what they're for!

Weekend at the Cider Mills

Make sure to use Clue 1. Each week is mutually exclusive, so the brief schedule eliminates a lot of possible combinations.

Clue 5: Neither Fuji apples nor hayrides were part of my hot cider week.

Clue 6: I ate cinammon donuts the same week as I visited the haunted house.

I'd Like to Solve the Puzzle

Board 1: This 1989 animated film is about a young girl in a new city.

Board 2: This movie stars Mandy Patinkin, Wallace Shawn and André the Giant is supporting roles.

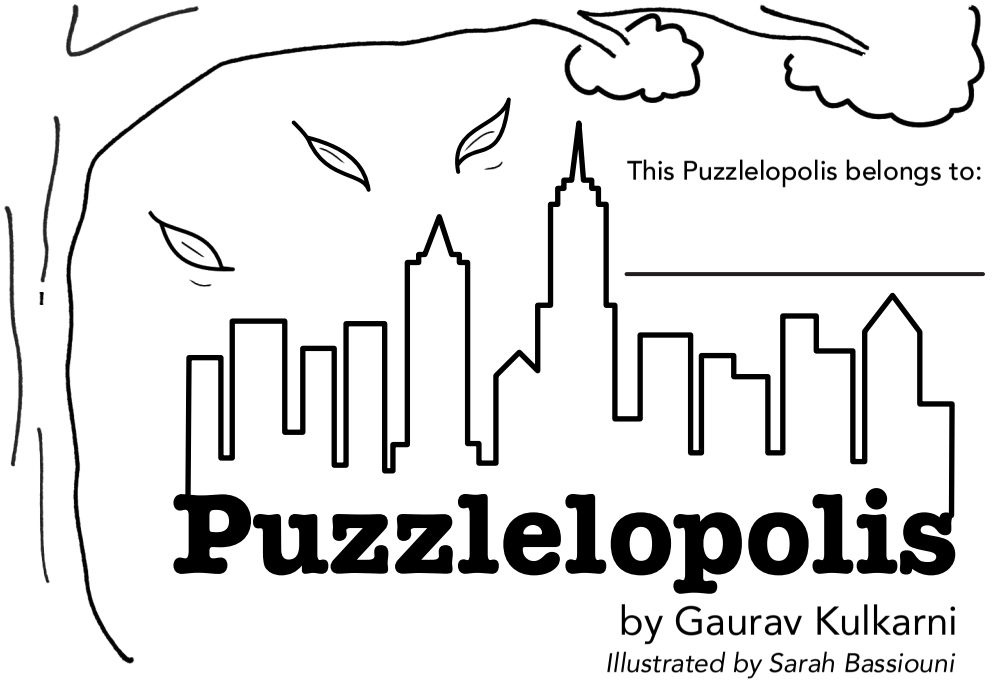
Board 3: This 1965 film was adapted from a Rodgers and Hammerstein musical with the same name.

Stay in touch! Share feedback, request copies for your office or friend group, or sign up to playtest future issues.

puzzlelopolis.com

puzzlelopolis@gmail.com

Answers to this issue can be found at **puzzlelopolis.com /answers/3.pdf**



This Puzzlelopolis belongs to: _____

Puzzlelopolis

by Gaurav Kulkarni

Illustrated by Sarah Bassiouni

A free puzzle booklet for fans of word and logic puzzles

Super Search Inside!

Also included inside:

Spiral Crossword

Murdle-style Logic Puzzle

Connect the Dots

and more!

Issue #3 · Oct 2026

Dear Residents of Puzzlelopolis,

If you're new here, you might be wondering what Puzzlelopolis is. Perhaps you picked this booklet up because the cover caught your eye, and you enjoy a little brain exercise. This booklet was made for you. I appreciate your curiosity! I make these puzzles because we could all use some time with paper and pencil, puzzling through little challenges.

This issue is dedicated to Fall. Fall is a time for change. It can be a time to let go of the things that haven't been working for us, to let them fall to the ground and make space for new growth. As we embrace this season, *what do you want to make more space for in your life?*

I publish Puzzlelopolis monthly. If you enjoy this issue, tell your friends! Grab another issue for the other puzzle nerds in your life. On the back page, you can find my contact info, as well as a link to the answer key. Now don your coziest sweater, get comfy, and let's do some puzzles!

Boxes in the Grid

Difficulty:

This is subjective, so don't fret if your sense of challenge doesn't match the leaves.

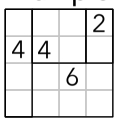
For this puzzle, subdivide the grid into **12 rectangles** where:

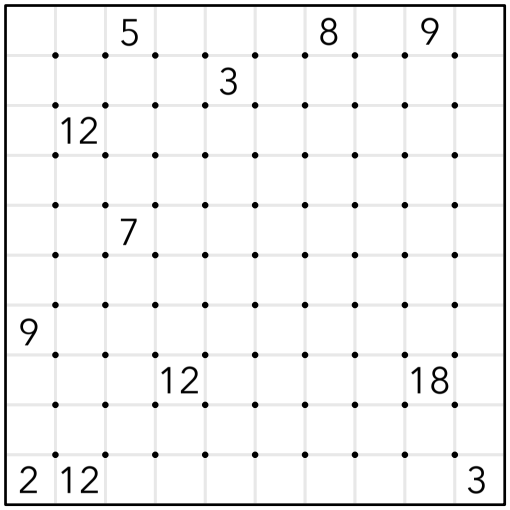
- Every 1x1 square in the grid belongs to one and only one rectangle.
- Each rectangle contains exactly one number.
- The area of the rectangle matches the number it encloses.

Start with the most forcing moves, and build out from there. The puzzle is designed so you never have to make guesses.

Note: Every shape must be a rectangle. No tetris pieces or other shapes!

Example





I'd Like To Solve The Puzzle

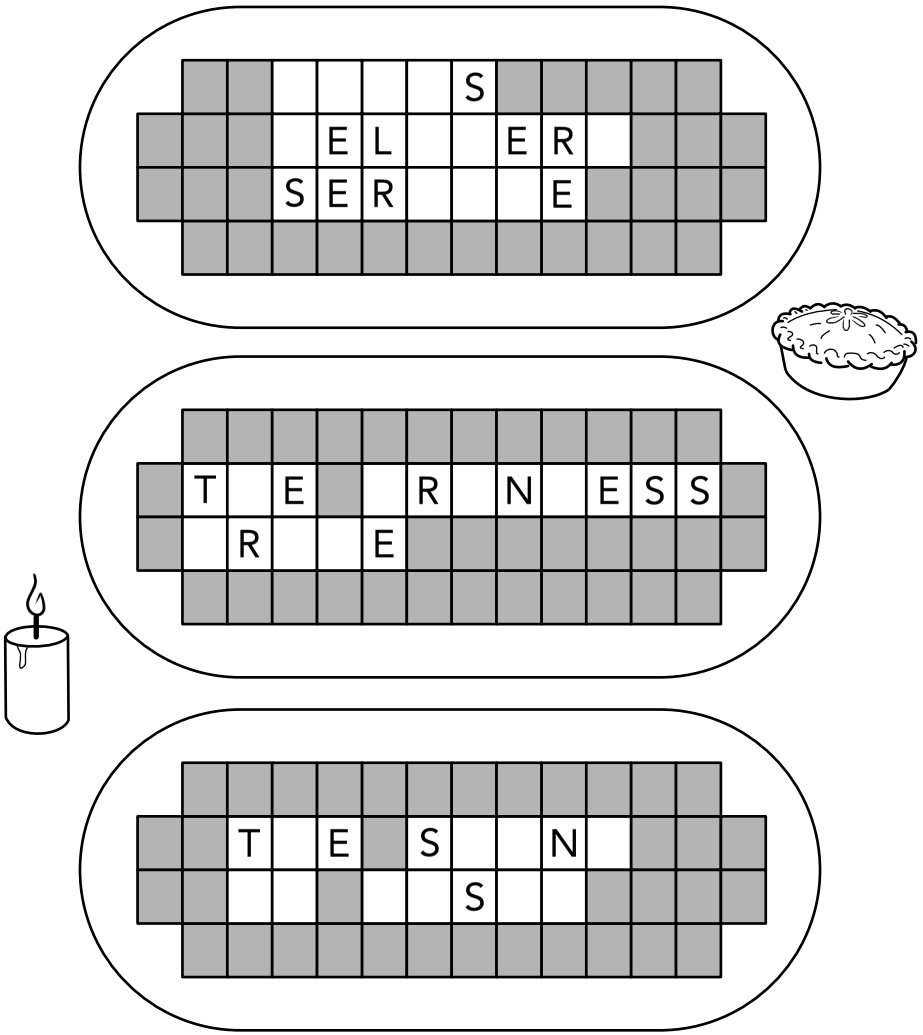
We're playing the bonus round of Wheel of Fortune. If you're unfamiliar, you need to guess what the phrase is on each of the boards below, given the available letters and the theme. Similar to Fortune rules, **I've given you the letters: R S T L N E**. That means every instance of those letters are revealed in the puzzles. It's up to you now to solve each puzzle, and win that car.

Note: If you get stuck, check the back of this booklet for hints.

Difficulty:

But only if you know the movies.
This one is a little more trivia-oriented.

Theme: Cozy Movies



Weekends at the Cider Mills

Difficulty: 

Might be more than 5 leaves. You can either really push yourself, or take a peek at some extra clues at the back of the booklet.

To really get in the fall spirit, I've been spending the last several weeks at different cider mills in Southeast Michigan. At each mill, I bought myself a *tasty treat*, participated in a *fun activity*, and then took home some *fresh apples*. It was a different treat, activity and apple variety each week. Be sure to use all of the clues to figure out what my full itinerary was each week. Use logical deduction to keep eliminating impossible combinations to find the answer!

Clue 1: Here's a schedule of a few things I did in the past four weeks:

Week 1: Hot Cider	Week 3: Corn Maze
Week 2: Haunted House	Week 4: Honeycrisp Apples

Clue 2: Cinnamon donuts weren't eaten at the petting farm or corn maze.

Clue 3: Between the honeycrisp and the gala apples, one was bought alongside maple taffy, and one was bought while visiting a petting farm.

Clue 4: I got a pumpkin pie the same day I took home empire apples.

		Apple				Activity			
		Fuji	Empire	Gala	Honeycrisp	Haunted House	Hayride	Corn Maze	Petting Farm
Treat	Hot Cider								
	Cinnamon Donuts								
	Pumpkin Pie								
	Maple Taffy								
Activity	Haunted House								
	Hayride								
	Corn Maze								
	Petting Farm								



Solution:

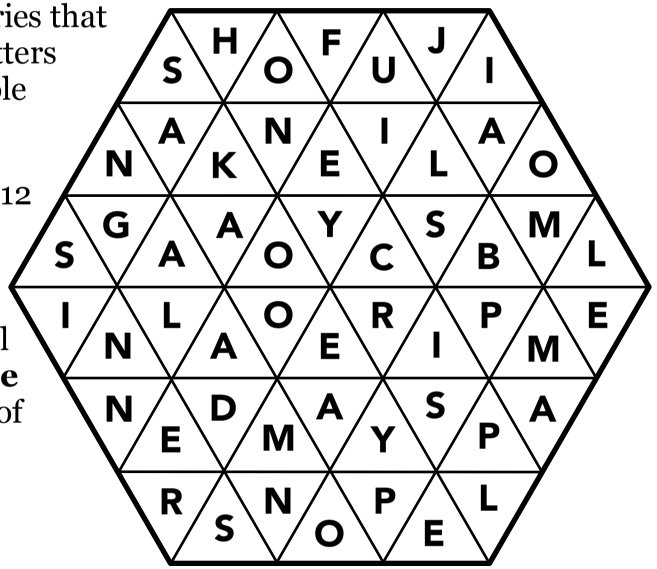
	Treat	Activity	Apple Variety
Week 1			
Week 2			
Week 3			
Week 4			

Autumnal Super Search

Difficulty: 

Perhaps the best part of living in the Ann Arbor area is the AADL Summer Game. Shout out to all the library staff that work on every part of the Summer Game. We are all so lucky to have them in our community. I have borrowed this puzzle format from the Summer Game, and it is called **Super Search**.

There are 12 words hidden below, that can be read in any direction (up, down, backwards or forwards). The 12 words are split up amongst three categories that you can see below. Letters may be used in multiple words.



Once you've found all 12 words, there will be **6 remaining letters** that aren't in any words. Those will spell out the **answer to the riddle** at the bottom of the page.

Categories

Types of Deciduous Trees

_____ _____ _____ _____

Apple Varieties

_____ _____ _____ _____

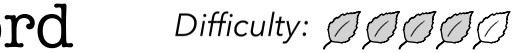
One Word Horror Movie Titles

_____ _____ _____ _____

Who did the skeleton take to the dance?

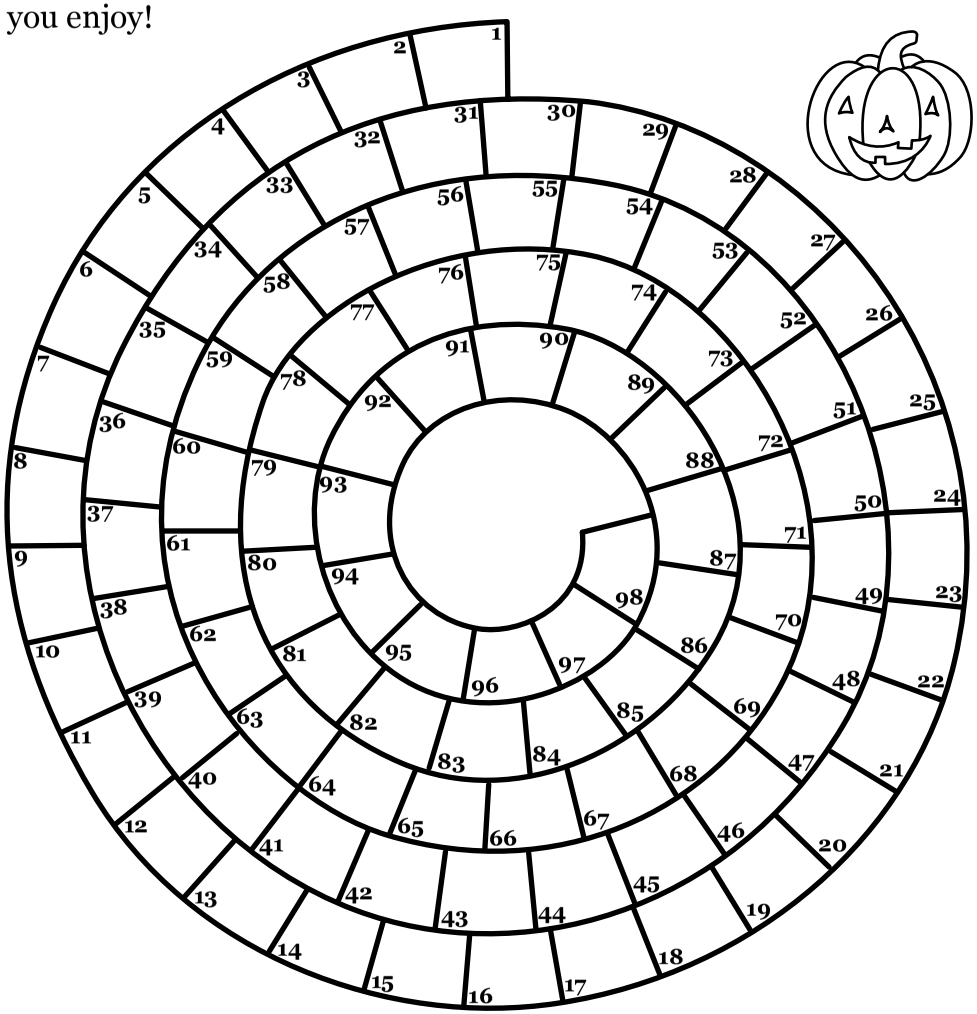
___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___

Spiral Crossword

Difficulty: 

This puzzle has two sets of clues, one spirals inwards and one that spirals outwards. Yes, that means the end-to-end solution is one set of words while reading in one direction, that spells a completely different set of valid words when read backwards. Like *stressed* and *desserts*. We call these words or sets of words **anadromes**, or my preferred term: **emordnilap** (which is palindrome spelled backward!)

I recommend jumping around to find your "gimmes", the ones that are easy to fill in. And then build out from there. If one direction doesn't make sense, try approaching it from the other side. I hope you enjoy!



Inwards

1-7: Makes a call
8-13: Cocktail with tequila, lime and grapefruit juice
14-24: The sweet life
25-29: Strongly desire what one does not have
30-35: What protects your teeth
36-39: Mosquitos are the ____ of my existence
40-46: Utter chaos
47-49: Turning ____, 2022 Pixar film.
50-53: Brooklyn NBA team
54-59: Type of silks used by acrobatic performers
60-63: It isn't basic!
64-70: Popular microcontroller platform for DIY projects
71-73: Strand of base pairs
74-80: Poker roguelike video game that was nominated for Game of the Year in 2024
81-85: Measure of distance
86-89: Something to work on at Pilates
90-93: Turn the knobs on a guitar or piano
94-98: Path in the woods

Outwards

98-95: One whose pants are on fire
94-92: Perfect score in diving
91-87: In ____, Nirvana's last studio album
86-82: The largest Greek island
81-76: Alive, but not forever
75-69: Leave behind
68-66: Device that prevents pregnancies
65-59: Awesome, in 80's slang
58-56: One of four ancient elements
55-46: British soap opera that has been continuously running since 1985
45-42: Opposite of receive
41-34: Open to the idea
33-29: French impressionist painter, Édouard
28-20: Like something that triggers strong memories
19-16: An oaf or a fool
15-11: Oft-remembered fort in Texas
10-6: Momentary _____ of judgement
5-1: Chopped into small cubes